MOUNTAINSIDE

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Ratification Gathering Now A Town Hall Meeting

In a response to member requests, the CMA Board of Directors voted unanimously to change the purpose of the April 9th agreement ratification meeting to a general membership meeting. The terms of a newly proposed agreement require that 2/3 of the membership approve certain provisions in the document. Some members have sought far more detailed information about agreement content and implementation plans and have requested an open forum. More information and more time will make for an informed electorate, so the board voted to extend the voting time, field questions, provide data and otherwise assure that all members who have questions or concerns be given ample opportunity to have their voices heard. Ballots that have already been cast remain in their original sealed envelopes and any members who wish to have a ballot returned pending further review of the facts will have their request honored. CMA is a democratically run organization and legitimate criticism of process or procedure is immediately acted upon. A new deadline date for balloting will be announced after April 9th.



SPRING! IT'S ABOUT TIME . . .

CACAPON STATE PARK IS THE CMA MEETING PLACE ON APRIL 9th AT 1:30 P.M. SHOULD BE INTERESTING!!!.

DON'T GO TO COOLFONT FOR THE APRIL 9th MEETING. WE WON"T BE THERE!. Drive down highway 522 to Cacapon State Park, turn right and drive to the main lodge. We'll be there to discuss the pros and cons of the new agreement and probably determine its fate! Nearly everyone who put it together will speak as well as all those with opposing points of view. You'll learn about the challenges of managing a community, new standards and regulations we must face and more than you want to know about our trials and tribulations. You'll meet your neighbors, our engineer, and some of our advisors. There are philosophic differences and a variety of approaches to problem solving among the membership, so the meeting is bound to be educational and useful as you support ongoing efforts to improve the community.

AN OLD TRADITION

MEMBERS SPEAK OUT- AS ALWAYS

When a member of CMA likes something or doesn't like something, we're all going to hear about it. Talk to Elmer Broxson, Past President (1977-79) and CMA Historian. Elmer reports a twenty year history of debates, open letters, speeches, law suits, injunctions, arbitration action and a plethora of freedom of speech actions. It speaks well for the community that so many are willing to stand up and be counted. Nearly 35% of the present membership has participated in elected or appointed positions! Three past presidents are active on a day-to day basis and nearly all full time residents are expert in the history

NEARLY 35% OF THE PRESENT MEMBERSHIP HAVE ACTIVELY PARTICIPATED IN CMA POLICY SETTING AND PROGRAM SUPPORT

of the organization and the development of the community. Interest and divergent points of view make for a strong organization, so all input is welcome. Nearly all members are, or were, leaders in their professions and avocations.

"I've learned that people who have mastered the art of living seem to be guided by an internal compass. They might not always stay on track, but they have a way of always returning to the proper course." - Age 63

From Live and Learn and Pass It On - H. Jackson Brown ,Jr.

POINT-COUNTERPOINT IS THEME . .

A NEWCOMERS VIEW

THE COFFEE STORY
by Arleigh Greenblat

I'm a newcomer. I've held one office in the association; President. My tenure has only been 177 days. I've worked with associations for twenty-five years. Some association work is fun and rewarding. Some association work is just plain tough. It doesn't take long to understand the culture of an organization; put in the hours, meet the people, listen carefully and in time, it all comes together. A facet of the CMA culture is best summed up in what I'll call the coffee story. At my first meeting, there was no coffee (or tea or soft drinks). All these professional people giving up their Saturday morning to serve their organization and not a soul said anything about coffee! Nobody said, " we always have had it, or it's your responsibility or "*sorry.*" Sink or swim! It was symbolic. My first act as a leader was to get the coffee (no, there was no charge to your treasury). It was just a small item, but to me it meant something. The next meeting coffee was provided and not a person attending said a word about it. Sure, we had plenty of hot topics and not much time for niceties. In a dark moment I wondered if we haven't been on top of other seemingly small items like thanking everyone for their efforts and I'm talking about over *all* the years. Thousands of volunteer hours by officers, committee chairpersons and committee people seem to have generated little official recognition. Maybe if we had thanked more people instead of using every waking hour to plan offenses against somebody or something, we'd be far more optimistic about the future and less likely to spend so many valuable hours looking back. Every success we've had lately is directly attributable to organizational sophistication which was gained through hard work and the contributions of our members. I'm new, but I've quickly learned about the efforts and hardships of my predecessors. Thanks are in order to all our volunteers. Looking forward to our next cup of coffee and hopefully together.

"TIMES THEY ARE A CHANGIN! - A SONG FROM THE '60s and the '90's.

A past officer remarked, " looks good but how are you going to monitor all this?" I started this way: Everything planned can be input into planning software. Computer calendars ring a bell when a deadline is not met. CMA topographical renderings are now in place on diskettes and can be generated in minutes. Past correspondence is now in computer memory. CMA labels and phone lists are all data entered and ready for immediate recall. Even our newsletter shell is in memory. Faxes automatically send the same document to a group without any more than a touch of a button.
Budgets and accounting records are computerized. Contractor performance milestones are now on computer reminder calendars; we can even print out milestone dates and attach them to contracts. *His eyes glazed over.* Modems? Memory? Mouse? Diskettes? Data Bases? Ram? Megabytes? Scanners? Get George Orwell's phone number, what is all this? Little old CMA is coming up to speed. Quietly, we've been getting our administrative house in order. It's the stuff winning laws suits are made of. Orderly data and data recall replaces wasted hours and allows for clearer direction for professionals and contractors who do our work. Sure, machines don't replace people, but for us, they're the right hand we never had. Was our man impressed? We don't know, he was on the way to shop for a typewriter ribbon!

FROM THIS POINT ON-
Past President Stan Bigelow
has graciously agreed to present viewpoints and questions about the course CMA leadership has mapped regarding infrastructure upgrades and expansion. In recent weeks, members have received letters from those concerned about any community expansion and extended dealings with the developer. Stan has helped to frame most of the key questions and issues to make sure they're "on the table." Stan made the request for a town meeting on behalf of several members. Holding the ratification process while members further study issues connected with plans being recommended by the Board of Directors will be in the association's best interest. Stan has opened his home and phone lines to members with concerns over the agreement. Some believe that the arbitration of the CDC-CMA dispute once begun, should have been continued. Trading common land is serious business and that also is of concern. Any opportunity for the developer to profit further is a problem for some.

Stan will be at the membership meeting. You may talk with him in advance.

Stan and Rosemary's address:
13 Coolfont, Berkeley Springs,W.V. 25411
Phone: 304 -258 5352

" The American people don't vote for what they don't understand."
Bob Dole

on Larry King Live last week